

From Student to Founder

CURRENT POSITION

Student — Data Analysis, Research & AI Skills

Strong analytical foundation, AI-native toolset, no business track record yet

TARGET GOAL

Launch a Profitable AI/Data-Driven Business in 12 Months

Fastest path: validated micro-offer → paying customers → repeatable system

SKILL GAP ANALYSIS

AREA	STATUS	DETAIL
Data Analysis	HAVE	Core strength — directly usable to build data/insight products and client deliverables.
AI Tools & Research	HAVE	High-leverage edge — lets you build & ship faster than most first-time founders.
Customer Validation	GAP	No experience testing demand before building. Critical to avoid wasted months.
Sales & Outreach	GAP	Need comfort with cold outreach, pricing conversations, and closing first customers.
Business Fundamentals	GAP	Pricing, basic finance, legal/registration basics not yet covered.
Personal Brand	GAP	No audience yet — needed to generate inbound leads and credibility.

LEARNING PLAN

- Customer Discovery & Validation — interviews, landing tests (M1–M2)
- No-Code / AI Build Tools — automate & ship an MVP fast (M2–M3)
- Sales & Positioning — outreach scripts, offer framing (M3–M4)
- Pricing & Basic Finance — margins, invoicing, runway (M4–M5)
- Personal Brand on LinkedIn — build in public weekly (M1–M12)
- Legal & Ops Basics — registration, contracts (M6)

SUGGESTED PROJECTS

Free "AI/Data Audit" Lead Magnet

Offer 5 free mini-audits to local businesses/students to prove value and build a case-study pipeline.

Micro-SaaS or Productized Service

Package a repeatable data/AI workflow (reporting, research, automation) into a fixed-price offer.

Build-in-Public Content Series

Document the journey weekly on LinkedIn to attract first customers and collaborators.

NETWORKING STRATEGY

LinkedIn Build-in-Public Post weekly progress, lessons, and wins to attract early customers and mentors.	Founder Communities Join student entrepreneurship clubs, indie hacker groups, and startup Discords/Slacks.	Warm Outreach Directly message 20 potential customers/mentors per month with a specific ask.	Campus & Local Events Attend pitch nights, hackathons, and startup meetups for partnerships and feedback.
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MONTHLY MILESTONES

Q1 · M1–3 Validate 10+ customer interviews, pick 1 niche offer, build landing page. Build MVP Ship a usable v1 using AI/no-code tools.	Q2 · M4–6 First Sales Land 3–5 paying customers via outreach. Systemize Set pricing, basic contracts, register the business.	Q3 · M7–9 Grow Brand 500+ LinkedIn followers, consistent inbound leads. Refine Offer Use feedback to improve product/service-market fit.	Q4 · M10–12 Scale 10+ active customers, repeatable sales process. Decide Choose: scale full-time, raise, or stay lean.
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IMMEDIATE NEXT ACTIONS

✓ This Week Talk to 5 potential customers about their biggest data/AI pain point.	✓ This Month Publish your first 4 build-in-public LinkedIn posts.	✓ Next 90 Days Ship an MVP and convert your first paying customer.
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